



IDS20370

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology

Flood Warning for the Inland Rivers SA

Issued at 12:11 pm ACST on Monday 18 May 2026

Flood Warning Number: 26

ELEVATED RIVER LEVELS CONTINUING ALONG THE WARBURTON RIVER AT POOTHAPOOTHA AND THE LOWER COOPER CREEK AROUND INNAMINCKA THROUGHOUT MAY

River levels along the Warburton River at Poothapootha Waterhole are elevated as are river levels along the lower Cooper Creek around Innamincka. High flows in the Warburton River and the lower Cooper Creek are expected to continue through May as flows arrive from upstream near the Queensland border.

Many roads and access tracks are impacted by flooding, in particular river and creek crossings. Transportation and movement of local communities and travellers are likely to be further impacted. Check road conditions before travelling.

Warburton:

River levels are elevated along the Warburton River at Poothapootha Waterhole. Elevated river levels are expected to continue through May as upstream floodwaters arrive.

Cooper Creek:

Creek levels are elevated along lower Cooper Creek at Cullyamurra Waterhole. The creek level is around 2.0 m above the Innamincka causeway and steady. Elevated river levels are expected to continue through May as upstream floodwaters arrive.

Safety Advice:

- Don't drive, walk, swim or play in floodwater because it is dangerous.
- Stay away from flooded drains, rivers, streams and waterways.
- Obey road closure signs. Plan ahead so you don't drive on flooded roads.
- Check the ABC and local media for updates. The situation can change quickly, so stay informed.
- For local emergency management warnings and advice visit www.ses.sa.gov.au/incidents-and-warnings/incidents-and-warnings-map/.

For emergency assistance call SES on telephone number 132 500. In life-threatening emergencies, call 000 (triple zero) immediately.

Next Issue:

The next warning will be issued by 01:00 PM ACST on Monday 25 May 2026.

Latest River Heights:

Location	River Height	Tendency	Time of Observation
Diamantina River at Birdsville	2.23 m	Steady	11:25 am Mon 18/05/26
Cooper Creek at Cullyamurra Waterhole	3.64 m	Steady	11:00 am Mon 18/05/26
Cooper Creek at NW Channel Upstream Coongie Lakes	4.61 m	Steady	11:00 am Mon 18/05/26
Warburton River at Poothapootha Waterhole	5.23 m	Steady	11:00 am Mon 18/05/26

This advice is also available by dialling 1300 659 219. Warning, rainfall and river information are available at <http://www.bom.gov.au/australia/flood>.